HD-010

Medium

Requested By

System Administrator

Domain

aklab.local

Service Requested:
Security Configuration access the Employees shared folder required for daily work.
Requested Action:
Configure the domain account lockout threshold, lockout duration, and reset counter interval through Group Policy on aklab.local.
Expected Outcome:
Domain user accounts are locked after four invalid logon attempts, helping protect against repeated password-guessing attempts. Verify the policy using a dedicated test account and document the results.

Environment: DC01 (domain controller) and CLIENT01 (Windows client)

1. Issue Description

The administrator wants a account policy such that the user accounts get loked after four invalid logon attempts.

2. Environment

- User account: AKLAB\Administrator
- Shared resource: N/A

3. Investigation

Looking for the current policies under default policy GPO:

File path: **Default Domain Policy [DC01] > Computer Configuration > Policies > Windows Settings > Security Settings > Account Policies > Account Lockout Policy**

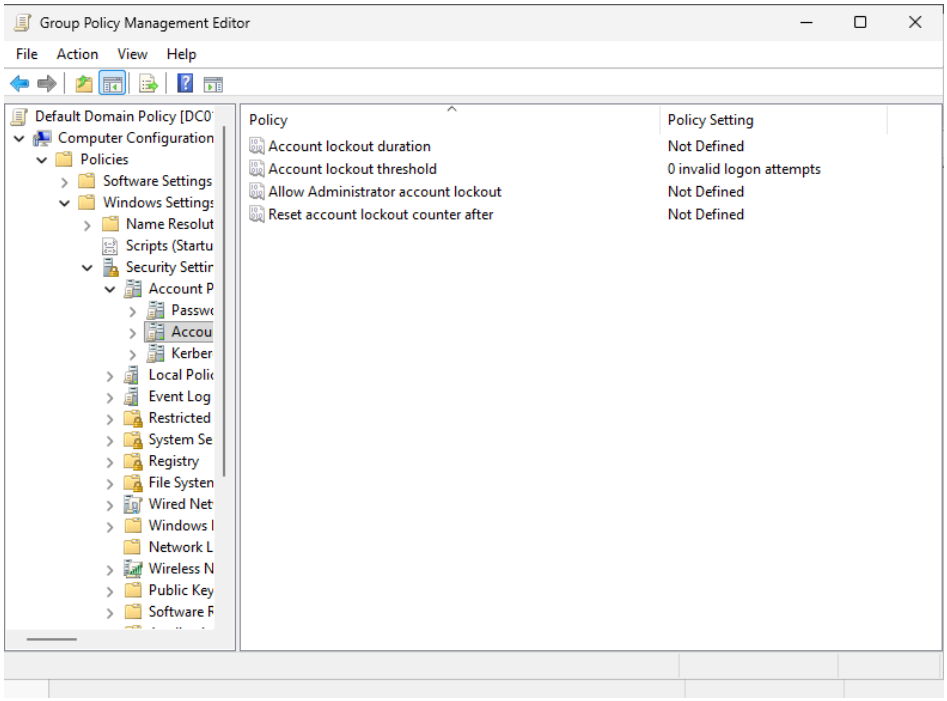


Figure 1: The current settings for the account lockout policy

The current settings are not configured; the user can attempt as many invalid logon attempts as possible without getting the account locked, which raises a security concern.

4. Resolution

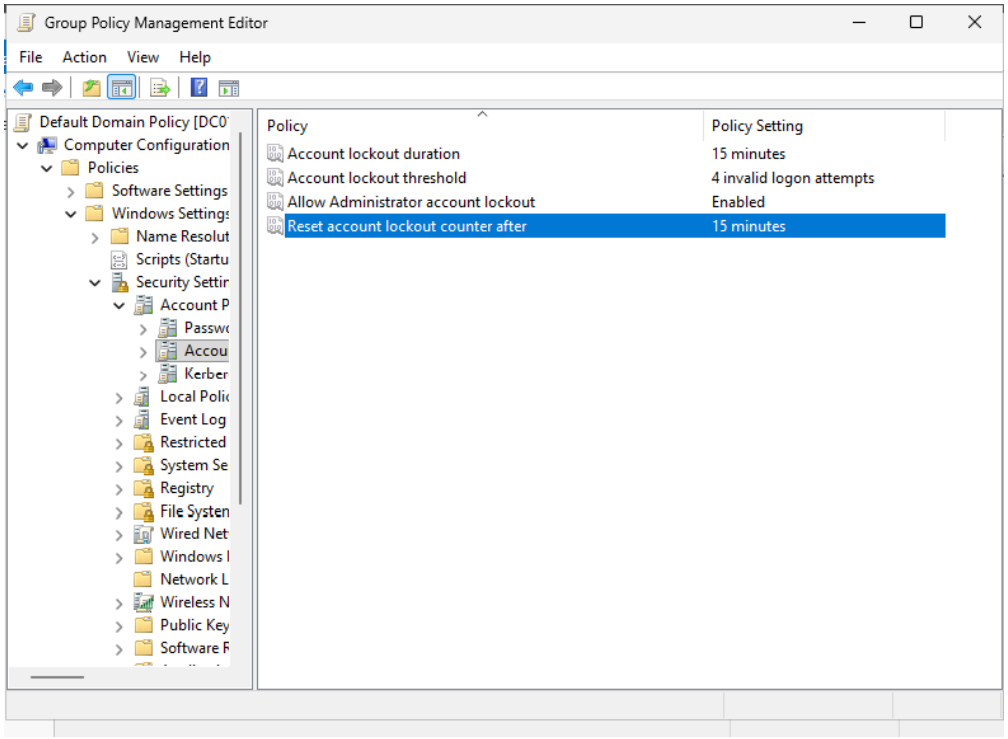


Figure 2: Configured the settings

As per the settings now,

Account lockout duration: 15 minutes

The account will stay locked for 15 minutes.

Account lockout threshold: 4 invalid logon attempts

Only 4 invalid logon attempts are permitted; after 4 invalid logon attempts, the account will lock automatically.

Reset account lockout counter after: 15 minutes

If a user makes 1, 2, or 3 wrong attempts, they must wait 15 minutes without making another mistake. If they stay quiet for 15 minutes, Active Directory forgets their previous mistakes and resets their bad attempts back to 0.

5. Validation

Verifying the results using a user account, validating the current policy using John Smith's account:



Figure 3: Logging in with incorrect passwords

Tried logging in with random passwords for four times in a row.

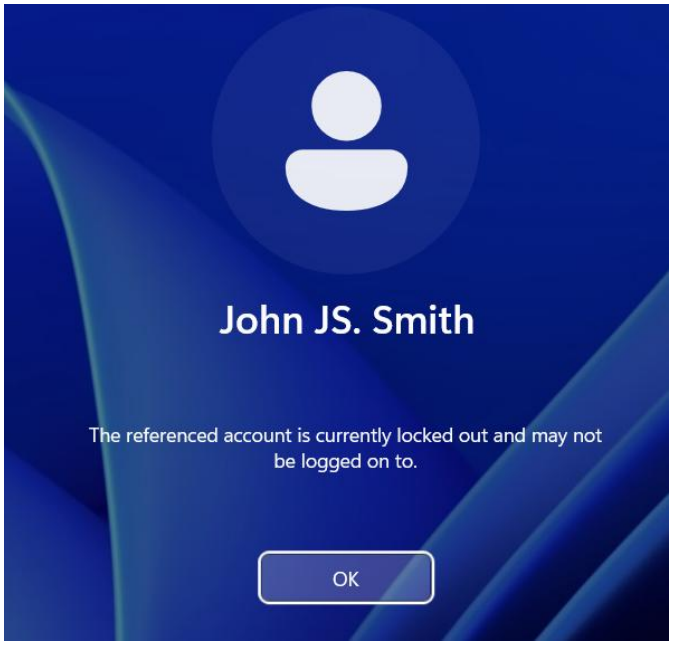


Figure 4: The account got locked after 4 invalid logon tried

Let's wait for 15 minutes and then try logging in again in the account:

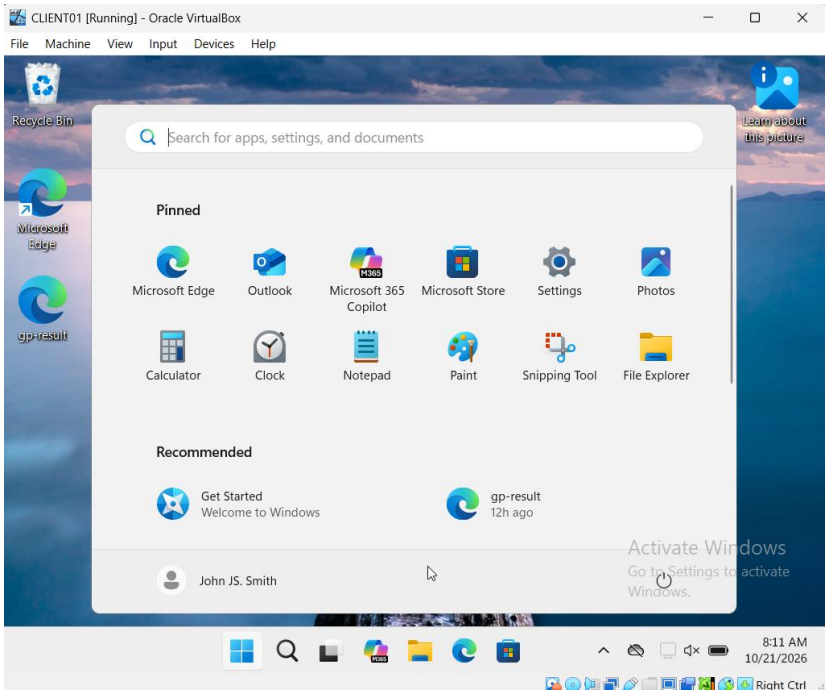


Figure 5: The user account is logged in successfully after 15 minutes

After 4 failed logon attempts, after 15 minutes have passed, make sure to fill in the correct password, only then the account will be logged in, otherwise, for other invalid passwords, the window will keep on saying "The referenced account is currently locked out and may not be logged on to.

Ticket Resolved!